

ALCHEMY AOE ALLIANCE

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HANDBOOK
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Handbook, Alchemy League Season 11

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1 - Referenced Documents

Table 1 below is a list of all specifications that are components to this one. Each of its entries were designed as an interchangeable part, to be used in context for this specification, or others like it:

Specification Number	Nomenclature
<u>MTHD-002</u>	Calculation, Tournament Elo
<u>MTHD-003</u>	Elo Correction, Handicap
<u>MTHD-004</u>	Discipline, Pa2 Round Robin
<u>MTHD-005</u>	Winner Selection, Round Robin
<u>MTHD-006</u>	Earnings, Round Robin
<u>MTHD-007</u>	Structure, Single Division Stack League
<u>MTHD-009</u>	Elo Calculation, Final
<u>MTHD-010</u>	Alchemy Treasury
<u>PSRM-FIW-1</u>	French and Indian War Maps
<u>STND-005</u>	Competition, General Rules

Table 1: Bill of Materials

If any part of any documents listed in Table 1 conflict with this specification, then this specification shall assume priority.

2 - Background

The *Alchemy Alliance (ALAL)* is a free and non-profit organization of random map scripters, tournament hosts, content creators, and skilled players dedicated to the advancement of custom random maps in Age of Empires II: Definitive Edition. As the nucleus of the *Alchemy AOE Community*, the *ALAL* publishes quality standards for custom random maps, and curates the finished products to be featured into thematic competitions where adventuresome players may exhibit creative strategies for maximum entertainment value.

3 - Overview

This handbook describes Alchemy League, a unique Age of Empires II 1v1 competition hosted by the *Alchemy Alliance*. As the most advanced AOE2 tournament in the world, Alchemy League boasts “big data” averaging of ranked elo calculation, a trade-secret single division stack matchmaker, and prizes awarded to players who most over-perform predictions. For maximum variety and entertainment, Alchemy League is played on Custom Maps with Standard Victory conditions.

4 - League Format

4.A - Team Size

The event described by this handbook is 1v1.

4.B - Structure

Single division Round Robin per MTHD-007 consisting of 3 Sprints with 2, 4, and 4 Rounds, respectively.

4.C - Games per Round

Matched participants shall complete 2, 3, or 4 games within the duration of each round, satisfying the conditions of this handbook.

4.D - Match Flexibility

Players may decide at any time how many games to play within the constraints of §4.C, for each particular Round. Additional games beyond the required minimum are played only if both players are willing. Once a game has begun, it cannot be aborted to prevent a loss. All games played in this format shall inform results and payout calculation, up to the maximum quantity recognizable per Round.

5 - Prize Money

5.A - Sprint Winners

The number of winners for each Sprint shall be either:

- Twice the number of Rounds described in §4.B, OR
- Top 5% of all players in the first sprint, then top 10% of all players in remaining sprints.

Whichever is greater.

5.A.1 - Participation Threshold

Regardless of fault, players shall complete more than 50% of minimum planned games each Sprint to be eligible for prizes.

5.A.2 - Winner Determination

Winning players calculated per MTHD-005.

5.B - Sprint Prizes

5.B.1 - Contestable

The prize pool for each Sprint shall be \$[30, 90, 180] USDC, respectively.

5.B.2 - Distribution

Contestable prizes (§5.B.1) distributed among winning players (§5.A.2) per MTHD-006.

5.B.3 - Currency Conversion

A currency conversion credit of \$1.50 USDC shall be added to the amount earned by each player from §5.B.2.

5.C - Payment Details

5.C.1 - Platform

Disbursed via Solana intermediary per MTHD-010.

5.C.2 - Originating Country

United States of America

6 - Timeline

6.A - Map Development

Start Date (YYYY-MM-DD)	End Date (YYYY-MM-DD)	Milestone(s):	Focal
Design			
~	2026-05-16	Advanced Releases, Map Specifications	Tournament
2026-05-17	2026-06-14	Original Issues, Map Specifications	Tournament
Creation			
2026-05-17	2026-06-07	Development, Phase One	Creators
2026-06-08	2026-06-14	Competitivity, Initial	Playtesters
2026-06-15	2026-06-21	Development, Phase Two	Creators
2026-06-22	2026-06-25	First Mundane Inspection	Creators
2026-06-26	2026-07-02		Tournament
2026-07-03	2026-07-09	Development, Phase Three	Creators
2026-07-10	2026-07-12	Final Mundane Inspection	Creators
2026-07-13	2026-07-19		Tournament
2026-07-20	2026-08-02	Competitivity Evaluation, Final	Judges
2026-08-03	2026-08-07	Slideshow Preparation	Creators
2026-08-08	2026-08-10		Tournament
2026-08-11	2026-08-17	Prize Voting	Community
2026-08-18	2026-08-20	Score Calculation	Tournament
2026-08-21	2026-08-25	Featured Map Selection	Creators

Table 6.A: Development Timeline, Alchemy League, This Season

The map development schedule is defined in this handbook for two reasons:

1. Applies regardless of final map pool selection per §8.A
2. Raises community awareness for opportunities to help play-test, inspect, etc. maps intended for future competitions. Help always welcome!

6.B - Competitive Play

Start Date (YY-MM-DD)	End Date (YY-MM-DD)	Milestone(s):	Sprint
2026-08-11	2026-08-23	Registrations Open	
2026-08-26	2026-09-08	Round 1	Sprint 1
2026-09-02	2026-09-15	Round 2	
2026-09-16	2026-09-17	Confirmation Public Scoreboard	
2026-09-18	2026-09-22	Results Calculation & Winnings	
2026-09-23	2026-10-06	Round 1	Sprint 2
2026-09-30	2026-10-13	Round 2	
2026-10-07	2026-10-20	Round 3	
2026-10-14	2026-10-27	Round 4	
2026-10-28	2026-10-30	Confirmation Public Scoreboard	
2026-10-31	2026-11-03	Results Calculation & Winnings	
2026-11-04	2026-11-17	Round 1	Sprint 3
2026-11-11	2026-11-24	Round 2	
2026-11-18	2026-12-01	Round 3	
2026-11-25	2026-12-08	Round 4	
2026-12-09	2026-12-10	Confirmation Public Scoreboard	
2026-12-11	2026-12-12	Results Calculation & Winnings	
2026-12-13	2026-12-14	Winners Provide Payment Addresses	
2026-12-15	2026-12-16	Earnings Sent, Season Ends	

Table 6.B: Competition Timeline, Alchemy League, This Season

For a total of 10 competitive rounds distributed across approximately 3 months.

7 - Matchmaking

Players shall be matched according to the following procedure:

1. Reference internet APIs to garner all alternate or “smurf” accounts corresponding to the same player, derived through IP address, Steam account sharing, and other methods.
2. Reference internet APIs to harvest all relevant match history corresponding to each of the accounts gathered from the previous step.
3. Calculate average ranked elo from 100 most recent games, linearly weighted per MTHD-002.
4. Perform a tolerance sweep on win rate and elo fluctuation over history to estimate sensitivity of ranked skill level, with 100% confidence interval.
5. Take average as the $\frac{3}{4}$ point going from minimum to maximum within that confidence window.
6. For returning players -- adjust $\frac{3}{4}$ point to account for previous performance per MTHD-009.
7. List players in order of skill and match per §4.B.
8. For each matched set of players, 100 shall be added to the lower of two elos and then MTHD-003 applied to determine corrective handicap (if any).

8 - Custom Map Information

8.A - Qualities

Community-created random maps per PSRM-FIW-1.

8.B - Featured Map

For each non-wild round, the host shall –prior to the start of the tournament– declare a map from the pool to be “Map of the Round” (see §8.D.1). Unless there are more rounds than available maps, a map cannot be “Map of the Round” twice in the same season.

8.C - How to Get

To protect creator intellectual property rights, the Alchemy AOE Community does not upload competition resources to the in-game mod center. Participants shall download the latest Alchemy League map scripts and place them in a folder suitable for integration into the game.

Recommended approach (~30 seconds): download and execute the following open-source scripts:

[Click Here for Windows OS](#) (batch script)

[Click Here for Linux OS](#) (shell script)

These executables were written and thoroughly tested by the community to automatically download and move the latest season's maps to the correct game folder. Most players run the scripts by saving to their desktop, then double clicking the icon, or right clicking for context menu, etc.

Direct control (~2 minutes): download the "Map_Archive" zip file from the Alchemy AOE Season web-page and extract to the appropriate game folder. Note that direct download is sometimes required for players with unusual PC configurations.

The Alchemy AOE Community server is webhook-configured to notify players of any changes to the seasonal webpage –the source of the custom map pool. Players are responsible for making sure they are using the latest versions by re-downloading after a map is updated. Tournament staff are eager to assist as needed.

Alchemy's map packs represent hundreds of volunteer hours to define, create, inspect, and playtest. Commercialization and/or redistribution of materials derived from the season web-page is strictly prohibited. Thank you!

8.D - Selection

8.D.1 - Round Normal

The first map played in a set is the "Map of the Round" per §8.B. Then, players take turns discarding the other maps until none remain. The purpose of the discard is to establish a preference hierarchy, not to eliminate anything. The map for each

additional game (however many that might be) is selected in reverse order of the “discard”. In this way, the “Map of the Round” is assured, no map is repeated within the same set, and preferred maps are played first (except “Map of the Round”).

8.D.2 - Round Wild

Lower seed selects enough maps for all possible games (E. G. five maps if maximum set size is Pa5). Higher seed decides the order to play some or all.

9 - General Settings

9.A - Civilization Selection

9.A.1 - Order

Civilizations selected after completing the process of §8.D.

9.A.2 - Restrictions

All Civilizations offered for ranked play by the official developers prior to August 2026 are approved for interaction with this season of Alchemy League. Draft links will not be updated to include any newly introduced civilizations while this season is underway.

9.A.3 - Draft

The following procedure applies:

1. Sixteen Randomly Applied Global Bans (administrator)
2. Eight Total Global Bans (players take turns, until each has four)
3. Eight Total Exclusive Picks (players take turns, until each has four; starting with one pick by the host, followed by taking turns of two picks of each for both players, ending with one pick by the host)
4. Two Hidden Snipes (each player applies one snipe in parallel)
5. Four Total Exclusive Picks (players take turns, until each has two; starting with one pick by the guest, followed by two picks of the host, ending with one pick by the guest)

9.B - Tournament Server

<https://discord.gg/h9DvzHBNPr>

9.C - Tournament Host

Direct all questions to TechChariot.

9.D - General Rules

Per STND-005.

9.E - Discipline

Administrative penalties assigned per MTHD-004. Maximum possible penalties per Sprint equal to 2 times the number of contained Rounds (see §4.B).

9.F - Eligibility

9.F.1 - First Sprint

Participants shall have 100 1v1 ranked games minimum and win rate between 15% and 85% totaled across all accounts.

9.F.2 - Other Sprints

Participants shall complete all previous Sprints without accumulation of excessive administrative penalties (see §9.E).

9.G - Registration Links

9.G.1 - To Sign Up

9.G.1.a - First Sprint

<https://forms.gle/RM2FF1fhMwGNjMo68>

9.G.1.b - Other Sprints

Eligible players auto-enrolled in subsequent Sprints unless otherwise indicated at least 24 hours before start.

9.G.2 - View Signups

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1_JdK4fVwqKA0esYv99ESvn-9c1FS1P_ex5P-me_b1hA/edit?resourcekey=&gid=986565802#gid=986565802

10 - Support

The Alchemy Treasury graciously accepts donations within the constraints of MTHD-010. Many thanks to the patrons who make Alchemy League possible.

Signatures:

TechChariot

2026-05-21

Prepared

*Date (YYYY-MM-DD)*Pl0tterGhost

2026-08-10

Checked

*Date (YYYY-MM-DD)*Honeybadger

2026-08-10

Approved

Date (YYYY-MM-DD)

Revision History:

<u>Revision</u>	Description	Change Document	Date (YYYY-MM-DD)
X1	Initial Advanced Release for community review/feedback.	N/A	2026-05-21
OI	----- Original Issue -----	N/A	2026-08-10
R1	§8.C, “Click Here for Windows OS” hyperlink location revised FROM: “https://github.com/f-istvan/Current-Alchemy-League-Map-Downloader/blob/main/current_season_maps_downloader.bat” TO: “https://alchemy-aoe-community.github.io/resources/alchemy_map_downloader_windows.bat” §8.C, “Click Here for Linux OS” hyperlink location revised FROM: “https://github.com/f-istvan/Current-Alchemy-League-Map-Downloader/blob/main/current_season_maps_downloader.sh” TO: “https://alchemy-aoe-community.github.io/resources/alchemy_map_downloader_linux.sh” §8.C, revised FROM: “These executables were written by the community to automatically download and move the latest season’s maps to the correct game folder. They are used by most players. <u>Click here for detailed instructions.</u>” TO “These executables were written and thoroughly tested by the community to automatically download and move the latest season’s maps to the correct game folder. Most players run the scripts by saving to their desktop, then double clicking the icon, or right clicking for context menu, etc.” §8.C, REMOVED: “Download button shown in Figure 8.C:  <u>Figure 8.C: Download Button Location (Github Preview)”</u>	N/A	2026-09-28